

02. GENERALITIES

DURATION : 08:38

STUDY SHEET

COURSE SUMMARY

This session addresses the importance of the environment in the development and well-being of individuals, highlighting the impact of emotional and physical contexts. Embryology is presented as anatomy in motion, integrating the notions of time and memory, essential for understanding bodily blockages. The concepts of body, mind, and spirituality are explored, establishing a link between osteopathy and epigenetics, while emphasising the importance of an integrative approach in therapeutic practice.

BIODYNAMIC EMBRYOLOGY: A HOLISTIC APPROACH TO LIFE

THE CRUCIAL INFLUENCE OF ENVIRONMENT AND SPACE

The **environment** in which we evolve is the driving force of our development. Take a seed: if you put it in the fridge, nothing will happen. But if you plant it in the earth, with light, sun, and warmth, it can develop.

Similarly, a complicated **emotional environment**, or any other, will have a major influence on us. We are talking more and more about **burnout**, and the strength of the environment accounts for almost **90%** of this power.

It is essential to consider our patients' **living environment**. I very often ask: "Where do you live? What are you experiencing? What have you experienced?" This is an anamnesis aimed at understanding the environmental "layer" surrounding the person.

To develop, we need two things:

- A **favourable environment**
- **Space**

Restoring space to the mind, tissues, and emotions is fundamental.

EMBRYOLOGY: FUNCTIONAL ANATOMY AND THE TEMPORAL DIMENSION

Embryology is functional anatomy. What does that mean?

- It is anatomy in **motion**.
- It is anatomy that uses the **4 to 5 dimensions** we know: up, down, left, and the fourth dimension, that of **chronos**, of time.

You will need to be able to observe this small developing embryo, its movements, and even through sections.

THE NOTION OF TIME AND MEMORY

This notion of **time** is also a notion of **memory**. You carry time within you; you are a concentration of time. Sometimes, in the body, there are specific areas where this concentration of time is blocked.

A word, a gesture, a look can block a person their entire life, and this can be found in the tissues. You may have noticed that after therapeutic work, an **emotional release** occurs. You have, in fact, released a concentration of time, allowing it to flow again.

In embryology, this notion is crucial because it allows us to rediscover this time. If you remember the film we watched this morning, there were movements where we moved forward, then suddenly, movements where we moved backward, like a wave.

If you observe such a movement, it means there are **points of support**. We will use these as therapeutic tools, because the body knows its points of support. If you give it a good point of support, it knows where it can develop, it knows how to rebuild itself.

THE UNITY OF BODY, MIND, AND SPIRITUALITY

There is the notion of time, tissues, fluids. Everything expresses itself in a **constellation**. It is said that "mind, body, spirit" are united.

Osteopathy is a science based on the art of touch, which offers a true understanding of the living body. It tells the story of anatomy linked to the movement of the spirit and mind.

One of the goals of osteopathy is to improve **exchanges** and to have an impact down to the **cellular** level. I even think we go further, with impacts on the human plane. We now see this through phenomena of thought and **epigenetics**. We have a very profound impact.

THE PATH OF LEARNING: FROM EMBRYOLOGY TO SPIRITUALITY

My professor proposed a path of study to me:

1. **Embryology**: Understanding embryology is understanding anatomy.
2. **Anatomy**: It gives us physiology.
3. **Physiology**: We must also study its pathology, its pathophysiology.
4. **Psychology**

5. Philosophy

6. Spirituality

Conception is how life develops. Anatomy is also how I die. Death, on a developmental level, is useful. If there is no cellular death, I prefer to speak of **transformation**. It is a continuous transformation.

THE LIFE FORCE AND TRANSFORMATION

This power, already established in the first cell, is present and continues until the end of your life, until your last breath. You have this ability to take the breath of life, to return it, and still have the energy to take it again. We participate in this at every moment. This is where transformation lies.

Sometimes, people are stuck in time and come looking for information about it. Very often, after attending these courses, something happens in their **predictions**. This is because we go into a space where the mind does not intervene directly, but where a modification occurs within.

We will observe the development of the "perfect" embryo, the **blueprint**, which maintains its midline, without deviation. This is the space of my conception. Sometimes, the midline is well aligned, but other times, one can be deviated from conception or at birth. This is **trauma**.

These points must be recognised. Non-recognition develops all compensatory activities. I must, at some point, through the quality of my presence, through the quality of touch, through what the tissue informs me, be able to recognise the impacts. And there, a **correction** can occur. One just needs to be present for the touch, because there is no will. This is what is truly important.

SELF-REGULATION AND THE FORCE OF NATURE

The body has a capacity for **self-regulation** and maintaining its health. This notion of the force of nature is about reconnecting with that. We see very clearly that if human impact disappears, nature quickly reclaims its rights. We have been somewhat cut off from this.

In this development, nature is there. The less we intervene, the better.

Another principle is the notion of **reciprocity** of structure and function. All these principles remind us that the body must be considered in its **totality**. We must realise that I can use this in my practice.

What I ask is simply that the body be **adjusted**. There are specialised drawings for little fingers, which is great. At the same time, they don't see that the lower or upper limb is an expansion of a **peritoneal sac**.

Atoms form **molecules**, molecules form **cells**, cells form **tissues**, tissues form **organs**. Ultimately, I am a bundle of atoms that move. But before the atom, there is also this whole notion of **energy**. What we perceive is a set of energy, a bundle of energy that sometimes needs to be structured a little, and which also thinks.

ONTOGENESIS AND PHYLOGENESIS

ONTOGENESIS

"Onto" means "being", and "genesis" means "formation". **Ontogenesis** is the formation of a being. We will study the ontogenesis of man, and especially his **morphogenesis**, that is, the formation of his shape.

PHYLOGENESIS

Phylogenesis traces the history of the development of all species through time.

We will study human ontogenesis, focusing primarily on the form and power of human development, and observing the impacts this can have at the practical level.